



MNCs LEAD THE WAY IN INDIA

DESPITE OUTWARD SIGNS OF ADVANCEMENTS, LGBTQ+ EMPLOYEES GLOBALLY FACE DEEP-ROOTED CHALLENGES AND FEARS ON THE JOB, FINDS A STUDY

1

Only 9.5 per cent of the surveyed organisations have made extremely significant efforts to be LGBTQ+ inclusive, of which a majority were MNCs

2

A vast majority (69.2 per cent) of the organisations surveyed made very limited efforts to be truly inclusive in their organisational approach

3

Only a small fraction (23 per cent) is putting in efforts to consciously hire people from the LGBTQ+ community. Within that, MNCs (62 per cent) formed the majority

4

Moreover, most of these hirings take place at the junior (33 per cent) and mid (31 per cent) levels

THE TOP 4 LEVERS OF MOTIVATION FOR MNCs TOWARDS DIVERSITY AND INCLUSION TARGETS

**COMMITMENT
AT THE GLOBAL
LEVEL**

**HIGHER
BUDGETS FOR
INCLUSION**

**ROLE
MODELS IN
LEADERSHIP**

**ATTRACTING
BETTER
TALENT**

LGBTQ+ POPULATION'S UNIQUE CHALLENGES DURING A JOB HUNT



TRANS

Low access to education; few open to hiring/treated as charity; few white-collar roles; blue-collar jobs follow 'default male' template. Need support for transition, washroom access, etc.



QUEER/ GENDER- FLUID/NON- BINARY

Low success in interviews if they don't follow a gender-binary appearance



ALL

Anxiety that identity/preference may cause subtle shunning. Need support for partner benefits

SOURCE RANDSTAD INDIA 'INCLUSION WITHOUT EXCEPTION' STUDY, JANUARY 2022

says Rangnekar. In fact, experts add, preparedness begins much before hiring a candidate. It must start with sensitisation of the workforce and reflect in the leadership, policy and programmes. Meesho, for instance, is mindful of the language they use in their communication and policies. "People watch how you define things and it makes them much more comfortable if you use neutral terms," says the e-commerce platform's CHRO Ashish Kumar Singh.

Giani points out that the firms usually carry out external initiatives first, followed by internal efforts. "It should be the opposite." And those that are indeed implementing policy changes are navigating several practical challenges. Take budgets, for instance. "Corporations often cite limited funds for D&I initiatives or relegate it to the HR department, when actually a separate D&I department headed and championed by senior leaders is required to drive it. By expanding their perspective, companies can unlock budgets from CSR, ESG, L&D, recruitment, etc., to integrate D&I into their organisational intent," says Kanishka Chaudhry, Co-Founder and Chief Impact Officer at Samavesh Chamber of Commerce for the LGBTQ+ community. Worse, some companies want to see quarter-on-quarter results, rolling back policies or slashing budgets when that is not the case or in tough economic conditions, the experts say.

INSTEAD OF EARMARKING

separate budgets, Tata Steel and P&G India have made it an intrinsic part of their mainstream recruiting, training and development. "It is not like